Broady, for instance, always wanted an extra cover with far greater enthusiasm than I could muster. Having one stubborn man telling another stubborn man what to do is not the recipe for an easy life. Our stand-offs on the pitch usually involved an agitated form of semaphore. Broady would be waving his arms this way and that, demanding positional changes. I love bowlers who know their own minds, but there are limits. Whereas others would be a bit more malleable, he didn't like taking no for an answer.

I had to strike that balance between being a dictator, a diplomat and a disciple. I knew that if I gave in to him consistently, there would be murmurings about my authority. Equally, I couldn't risk alienating him, or suggesting to the others that I was inflexible. Ultimately, I loved him. Whisper it, I still do. Anyone who gives so much deserves a certain latitude.

The South Africans restored a modicum of pride by winning the final Test at Centurion. Morkel got me out in both innings – for 76 and 5, respectively. Kagiso Rabada, aged only twenty, took thirteen wickets in the match. We were obviously disappointed, but it meant that, to a degree, everyone had something to celebrate when the teams congregated in the home changing room afterwards.

This was a session with a difference, because it featured a fines meeting. It was a bit like a rugby players' court and operated on the principle that anyone could impose a punishment, on teammate or opponent. The explanation didn't have to be particularly plausible, but it carried consequences if it wasn't deemed impressive. We enjoyed each other's company and were happy to share the stick.

As captains, AB and I were nailed early, and often. I fined Quinton de Kock, because he missed the Wanderers Test after twisting his knee falling over, supposedly walking his two Jack Russells the previous afternoon. Dane Vilas, his replacement, arrived an hour after the match started, despite a police escort, at the end of a comical 1,000-kilometre dash to Johannesburg by plane and train from Port Elizabeth.

Their media officers had tried to hush it up, but Dean Elgar, the South African opener, obviously hadn't been briefed on the cover story, and blurted out the tale of two little dogs. I slaughtered Quinton, light-heartedly suggesting that was the worst excuse I'd heard for getting pissed on duty. Rabada chimed in, fining Nick Compton for batting with only one eye open, like a drunk trying to find his way home. It was a great couple of hours, harmless fun, sporting banter as it should be.